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BRIDGE OVER THE LIVER AND THIGH

"I'm so aggravated, I could spit," growled Ike. "All those great deals at Costco, and I can't touch them. One club."

"So why do you go already, to be tormented and frustrated? One diamond." said Hannah, cautiously counting her points.

"Listen carefully Ike", counseled his partner, Gertrude, "TWO hearts.....you're listening? And why get upset about the bargains, which are no bargains if you can't use all that stuff."

"You can save lots of moolah if you have a place to store the goods. Two spades." offered Max.

Ike reviewed his cards and said excitedly, "Gerty, I'm talking to you...three no trump! Got it? Is there a solution to this Costco thing? I feel like I'm losing money and a great opportunity by not buying there."

Hannah reviewed her cards again, shrugged her shoulders and said, "I pass. But I have an idea if the rest of you are open minded. We could all go together, on Ike's membership card, choose the best buys, and split it up."

Gertrude's face flushed pink as she responded with, "Four no trump. And I like Hannah's idea about sharing the bill and the merchandise. Besides, their all beef hot dogs would make a delicious lunch and we could make a day of it."

Max frowned and muttered, "Pass".

The friends had been meeting for a weekly bridge game for almost twelve years and looked forward to a change of pace activity by planning the excursion to Costco. The following week, they readied themselves for the new adventure, equipped with comfortable walking shoes and calculators. Ike offered to drive but was politely turned down because he, after all, paid for the membership, and shouldn't have

to take care of the gas as well.

They arrived as the doors opened and immediately headed for the free coffee and muffins.

"Already we've gained benefits", grinned Gerty.

"You'd better believe it." agreed Ike as he eyed Gerty's burgeoning figure. "Let's go up and down the aisles and save the food items for last. We don't want them to melt or spoil or anything."

"I'd like to check out the auto section. There are a few things I need." said Max.

"Oh pooh", lamented Hannah. "That's guy stuff. Go with Ike if you want to spend time with those macho things. Gerty, do you want to see what they have in ladies clothing? I could use a nice purse."

After an hour and no purchases, the group reconnoitered and decided it was time for lunch.

"Those purses were high quality," remarked Hannah as she dabbed some relish from her chin, "But I think I can get a better deal at Ross's especially if I go on Tuesdays, seniors' discount day.

"You're giving yourself away," smiled Max. "I never thought I was playing bridge with a silver fox."

The group finally agreed it was time to visit the food section.

"I've been requested to make my famous chopped liver dish for the Sunshine Committee's pot luck luncheon. What gorgeous chicken livers they have here, but you hafta buy ten pounds of it! Two and a half pounds would be perfect. What do you say pals?" queried Hannah.

"Personally, I always use baby beef liver and mine comes out the best in the world; better than my own mother's.", declared Gertrude.

"I hate all kinds of liver", asserted Ike.

"I'm nauseous", admitted Max.

There still remained chicken parts of every description.

"Just look at this lovely chicken. All these plump thighs; such high quality. We can surely split this large tray full," said Gertrude hopefully.

"How about if we make it drumsticks? I'd go for that." offered Ike.

"I love the wings. All those bones fill the meat with lots of calcium and that's very important at our age. What do you like Max?" asked Hannah.

"I'm a breast man myself!", smirked Max.

They exited the area with no liver, no chicken, no nothing! As they left Costco, there was a large basket where customers could write their names and addresses, drop it in the hope chest and win valuable prizes.

The mission had been a failure, but the friends met, as usual, for their bridge game. As the cards were distributed, Max said, "Guess what I won from Costco?"

"You won a prize?", exclaimed Hannah.

"Yeah, I won a free membership to Costco", griped Max.

"So when are we going?", asked Gertrude.

Max simply said, "I pass!"

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